GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

November 14th, 2025
Week 46
Volume 278, Issue 1211

Highlights:

- **Precarious.**
- **Activity rises.**
- **Price lull.**
- **HKC diligence.**
- **Socially busy.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

""The only one who can tell you 'you can't win' is you, and you don't have to listen."

– Jessica Ennis

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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DESPERATE DOWNERS?!

With the last 6 weeks of 2025 now firmly on the horizon, the final stretch of the year continues to demonstrate its sheer unwillingness to compromise as global economies are still reporting volatile movements of commodity prices and oil futures that are still unfolding with each passing week. But the ship recycling market economies are the ones generating even more confounding results amid an increasingly precariously posture at just how this momentum has been unravelling over the last 3 – 4 years and is now expected (feared) to likely continue deep into 2026.

While the Baltic Exchange Dry Index reported gains once again this week on the back of virtually all inclusive sub-sectors reporting improvements of their own through the week, oil futures on the other hand seem to be taking a beating after levels clocked the week out at USD 59.50/barrel after Ukraine successfully carried out a massive drone attack against Russia's largest oil refinery located at Novorossiysk. The U.S. Dollar meanwhile continues its carnage across the globe as it firmed at nearly all locations across the board while local steel plate prices in the two steady recycling destinations retreated in varying degrees.

This double gut-punch targeted at the purchasing prowess of the ship recycling fraternity has driven demand and vessel offerings even further down this week as vintage tonnage starts to unexpectedly arrive at anchorages i.e. Bangladesh, which healthily beat India's beaching quota for this week. Moreover, with freight rates continually rising / yielding profitable results for relevant stakeholders, recycling sales have been slow for the most part of the year even though sales activity has comparatively picked up a touch since the barren summer slump. Worse yet, many of the transactions concluded are at levels far below expectations and in the low USD 400s/LDT, with several reportedly in the high USD 300s/LDT on less preferred / small LDT tonnage.

Meanwhile, the poorer placed India and Pakistan continue struggling to register any worthwhile levels for owners / cash buyers despite the supply of older dry bulk units – particularly vintage handymax and panamax units including small -to medium- sized-tankers – registering an increase in the number of candidates being proposed for recycling. Yet, just how many are actually being concluded amidst a sea of boring offers remains inconclusive even though several end-of-life MR tankers, smaller product tankers, and a steady stream of occasional LNGs have kept ship recycling markets from dozing off completely in the latter part of this year.

Finally, as HKC developments have taken precedent over filling plots and with mandatory yard upgrades marring the recycling progress, Bangladesh remains with only 18 HKC approved yards while Pakistan is at the tail end of the race as it awaits its first HKC approval. And as the shipping calendar remains busy with various events over the past month or so, including Bahri week last week in addition to the recycling world convening in Hong Kong for the annual Tradewinds Ship Recycling forum, it remains a busy time for the industry – all while Turkey remains alone at the USD 2XX/Ton party awaiting a lone passerby.

BANGLADESH

BARREN, YET BOLD?

Influx.

Despite all their efforts and firmer offers emanating out of Chattogram, very few market sales have been realized of late. Yet, it does seem as though several private units including those idling in cash buyer inventories that were likely awaiting a positive market movement without much luck, have clearly helped local recyclers this week as Chattogram's waterfront reported an influx of tonnage that saw 7 vessels and nearly 66K LDT suddenly arrive the nation's recycling anchorage just this week, including at least one large 21K LDT dry bulk unit.

Barren 2025.

An anemic yet growing demand from an increasingly hungry / desperate set of local recyclers of late has likely attributed to this outcome since Bangladesh has suffered a nearly barren 2025 ever since the HKC came into effect - save for a promising start to the year that essentially banked primarily on large LDT dry bulk / LNG units, we have seen very few vessels heading to Bangladeshi shores since June.

New Twilight.

30% tariffs, overly paralyzing monsoons, political instability and unrest over the upcoming February 2026 elections, economic downturns, volatile inflationary figures, a collapsing Taka, and recently retreating local steel plate prices have all been delivering a death of a thousand cuts to the local ship recycling mindset over the last 2 quarters. In fact, just this week, we saw the Taka plunge nearly 40 basis points down to BDT 122.35 against the U.S. Dollar, whilst local steel plate prices took up the challenge and fell a meager USD 1/Ton after flatlining for the entire week.

With political violence now being reported, even day-to-day life in Chattogram seems to be coming under stress as daily headlines news on security lapses make the rounds as economic activity in the nation continues to take a hit. And with a healthy level of incoming units this week, it is very likely that we see the Bangladeshi ship recycling market enter a new twilight of absence at the bidding tables.

Unchallenged.

Time will tell.

For now, the forecast for Bangladesh's 2025 end remains unchallenged and otherwise expectedly barren for the most part, unless some of the better numbers for select tonnage seen over recent times continue to hold, especially as the industry moves towards the crucial local elections ahead.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

VIEW FROM BELOW!

Alang's slide down the foothills of the price rankings mountain has seen an increasing silence descend across the industry, given that India has been the only worthwhile destination to seriously consider of late, with a far more capable set of local recyclers and a strongly established HKC base. And as clearly evident from this week's port position, this still seems to be the case given that a bunch of smaller LDT units, which more than likely did not find a retirement spot on the beaches of Gadani, have happily ended up in Alang instead.

Silence descends.

And with little demand and minimal offers emanating from the largest and most HKC approved destination in the world today, such a reticence and disillusionment over the ongoing performance of industry is a worrying factor and for what has been an overall declining and lethargic market over the course of 2025 and even back in 2024, where levels not-since-seen the highs of USD 600/LDT has turned the business of ship recycling into a struggle for survival for the 100 HKC approved yards that still stand in operation today.

USD 600/Ton?

The crushing decline in supply has maintained posture and the sporadic flurry of incoming units certainly deceives the number of deliveries the entire sub-continent has otherwise been acclimatized to and left even ship owners and cash buyers worrying where their end-of-life assets will eventually price out on the books, especially as fundamentals continue taking a hammering. The Rupee lost 11 basis points to end the week at Rs. 88.70, local steel plate prices were the only ones to make an unexpected turnaround by about USD 4/Ton, though it remains far from stable territory to where acceptable offerings on smaller LDT dry units could scrape past USD 400/Ton.

Hopes ahead.

Seems 2026 is gearing up to be a playback of 2025 with its own flavour of unexpected coming the industry's way – especially given how things are playing out worldwide.

Unexpceted.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

REDUCED OUTPUT!

Under performing.

After an altogether (comparatively) healthier few months of deliveries and reported yard upgrades that have yet to deliver the nation's first HKC approved ship recycling yard, the Pakistani market's performance continues to leave an unimpressive mark on the industry with lackluster offerings at the bidding tables, assurances of compliance via provisional DASR certificates, poorly performing economy, an inflation that has more than doubled in the span of a couple of months, and a local ship recycling mindset that is being hammered by the inflow of far cheaper Iranian product that continues undercutting local steel plate prices.

Lowly does it.

In fact, we finally saw the first signs of this hitting the domestic ship recycling community where it hurts most, in local steel plate prices that not only opened the week lower than last, but remarkably, managed to even decline a whopping USD 13/Ton and below the USD 600/Ton mark for the first in a few quarters. Not to be outdone, the PKR too fell about 11 basis points and closed the week out at levels approaching PKR 283 against the U.S. Dollar, at PKR 282.80.

This has left Gadani positioned just above a lackluster Alang and leaving not much else on the table in terms of safe redeliveries. Case-and-point, if a tiny 1400 Ton straggler can manage to remain stranded at anchorage for nearly 2 months, it certainly leaves no room for owners / cash buyers of larger LDT units to risk the Pakistani market, especially amidst this ongoing decline.

Pressure needed.

HKC hurdles have certainly left this market stranded in the face of the competition as no new vessels have arrived Gadani this week and authorities will ultimately have to fuel progress at yards in order to remain relevant. Even with incoming cheaper steel product, higher tariffs on imported steel need to be imposed so that the state of affairs doesn't cannibalize local business viability.

The big question remains, when and how soon will any of this come into effect as it is clear that Pakistan will likely spend the rest of the year (like India) in a disheveled state. Worse yet? Much like the last 2 years and especially 2023 have turned out, where a meager 16 vessels were delivered locally over the entire year, to snap that figure into perspective, this is the number of vessels across all anchorages just this week.

A truly disappointing turnaround for such a big market.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

SO, WHAT ELSE IS NEW?

High-stakes.

Can't talk about the weather in here but there's just little to discuss about Aliaga. And sadly, there's nothing other than the perennial decline of the Lira to first highlight as it declined a healthy 25 basis points into neverland and passed TRY 42.30 against the U.S. Dollar, making the recent price hike in the face of declining fundamentals that much more confounding.

The price of hoping to remain in business is certainly high stakes.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 46 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Weak**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	380 / LDT	400 / LDT	410 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	260 / LDT	270 / LDT	280 / LDT

SPACED OUT!!

- ***Space isn't completely silent.*** *Electromagnetic vibrations, like plasma waves or magnetic field interactions, can be translated into sound by instruments. NASA has even 'sonified' data from stars, black holes and nebulae, turning invisible cosmic phenomena into eerie soundtracks.*
- ***The Moon is lemon-shaped.*** *Despite its appearance in the night sky, our natural satellite is nowhere near round. In fact, the Moon is shaped like a lemon, with flattened poles and bulges on both the near and far side around its equator. This strange shape is thought to have been created during interactions with Earth soon after its formation.*
- ***Milky Way smells of rum, raspberries and booze****. In 2009, astronomers exploring a giant cloud of gas and dust at the centre of the Milky Way made a surprise discovery. The cloud was packed full of a chemical known as ethyl formate, which has a couple of intriguing properties. It is responsible for giving raspberries their flavour and has the smell of rum. Another nearby region is full of ethyl alcohol, or ethanol, the type we use to make alcoholic beverages. It contains enough alcohol to supply everyone on Earth with 300,000 pints of beer per day for a billion years! If bottled at source, the proof for this beer would be low, with an alcohol content of less than 1%. But as the cloud also contains plenty of other nasty chemicals, among them carbon monoxide and hydrogen cyanide, it would still leave you with quite a headache the next morning.*
- *On Mercury a day is twice as long as a year. Technically, one Mercurian day lasts 59 Earth days, while a year lasts 88. However, due to Mercury's very eccentric orbit and alignment with the Sun, the length of time from sunrise to sunrise, known as a 'solar day', is equal to 176 Earth days — twice as long as a Mercurian year.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
No holidays in November	November 04 – November 11 November 18 – November 25

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
No holidays in November	November 04 – November 07 November 18 – November 21

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
November 09 – Iqbal Day	**No holidays in November**

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ALANG - Port Position as of November 07, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Ark*	*1,366*	*General Cargo*	*Delivered November 06*
2	**Conica Atlas**	**20,001**	**Oil Tanker**	**Arrived June 13**
3	Dalia	1,368	General Cargo	Arrived November 04
4	*Masal*	*23,159*	*Oil Tanker*	*Delivered November 06*
5	Rimba Empat	3,193	General Cargo	Delivered October 28
Total Tonnage		**49,087**		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of November 07, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	*Ang*	*2,631*	*Barge*	*Delivered November 04*
2	*Ang Ho*	*494*	*Pusher Tug*	*Delivered November 04*
3	**DK 03**	**7,809**	**Bulk Carrier**	**Arrived August 04**
		10,933		

GADANI - Port Position as of November 07, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Asmaa Z	7,078	Bulk Carrier	Arrived October 28
2	**Eena 1**	**1,444**	**General Cargo**	**Arrived September 27**
Total Tonnage		**8,522**		

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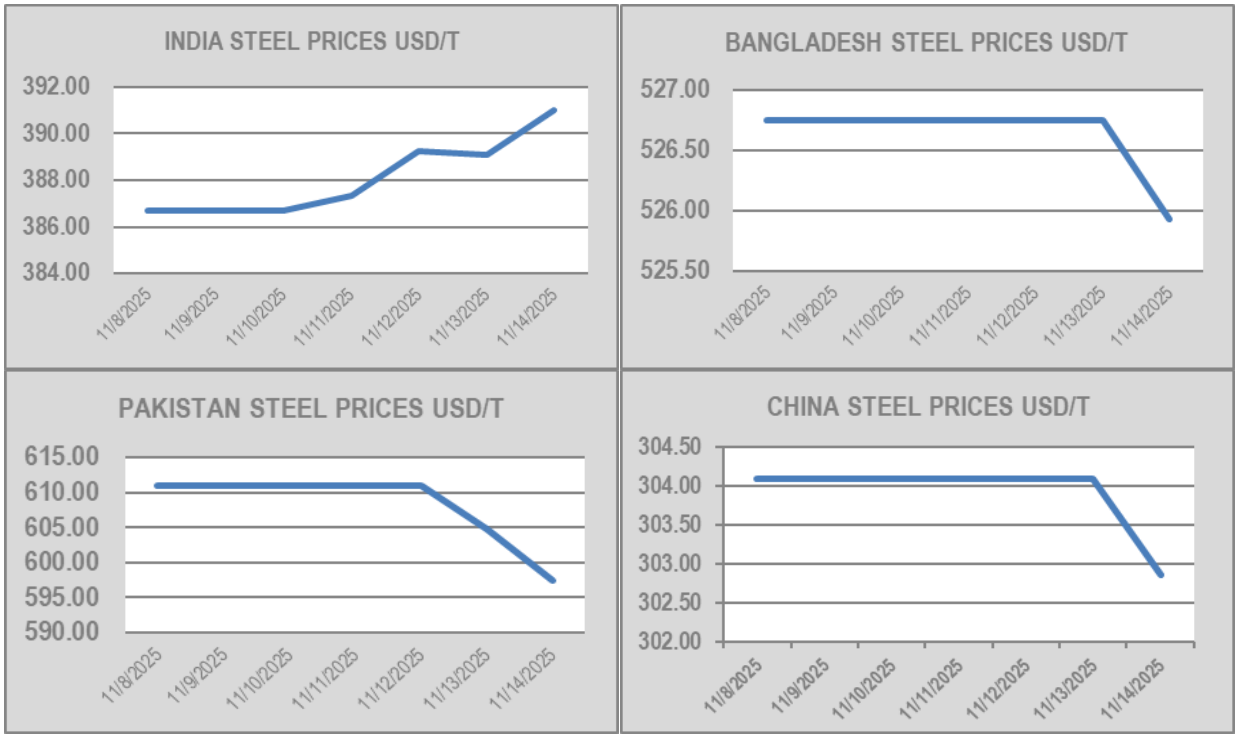
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
11/8/2025	386.70	34,300.00	610.90	172,000.00	526.75	64,000.00	304.10
11/9/2025	386.70	34,300.00	610.90	172,000.00	526.75	64,000.00	304.10
11/10/2025	386.70	34,300.00	610.90	172,000.00	526.75	64,000.00	304.10
11/11/2025	387.31	34,300.00	610.90	172,000.00	526.75	64,000.00	304.10
11/12/2025	389.26	34,500.00	610.90	172,000.00	526.75	64,000.00	304.10
11/13/2025	389.08	34,500.00	604.66	170,000.00	526.75	64,000.00	304.10
11/14/2025	391.03	34,700.00	597.44	168,000.00	525.93	63,900.00	302.86



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